

active game-like entertainment apart from the conventional photographic and video pornography. The Internet also provides easy access of porn to consumers in those countries where pornography is illegal—such as India or China.

Pornographic Web sites are also some of the biggest spammers on the Internet today. If you do not believe in this statistic, just have a look at your junk mail folder. The other major issue raised against pornography is the showcasing of illegal material such as child pornography and bestiality. Doctored pictures of celebrities also abound the Internet. With tools such as digital video cameras and camera phones, anybody's picture can be morphed into a pornographic image. You can imagine the implications of having a nude picture of you posted on the Net.

Another major gripe against Internet pornography is the usurping of domain names. Sites such as Whitehouse.com attracted a lot of unsuspecting surfers, hoping to get some information about the US government. They, however, were treated to some explicit nude images of err... 'interns'. Thankfully the site has since been stopped, but such threats can be worrisome, as unsuspecting underage people might end up wandering into such sites.

There are various ways to tackle pornography. You can install software such as Net Nanny that monitors your computer and restricts users from visiting unauthorised Web sites. Browsers, too, have inbuilt restrictive features that can be used to prevent viewing of certain sites. The next chapter includes a section on 'Porn Blockers' that can be used to specifically block pornographic Web sites.